

Recognise Earth is a planet in the solar system and identify patterns in the changing position of the sun, moon, planets and stars in the sky

Learning intention

- recognise Earth is a planet in the solar system and identify patterns in the changing position of the sun, moon, planets and stars in the sky.

Teach and model

- exploring representations of the solar system and identifying Earth and other planets.
- viewing a time lapse video of the sun, moon, stars or a satellite's movement across the sky.
- observing and describing short-term and longer-term patterns of events that occur in the sky.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.